

This is a copy of a shared ChatGPT conversation
Report conversation

 Uploaded an image  Uploaded an image  Uploaded an image
 Uploaded an image  Uploaded an image

and also these website inspirations:

<https://www.designprompts.dev/flat-design>

<https://www.designprompts.dev/material-design>

Absolutely. I think we should treat this as a **real product design project**, not just "making a portfolio."

One note before we start: I **can't directly read the contents of your Google Doc unless it's publicly accessible**, and LinkedIn only exposes a limited preview without logging in, so I can only extract the information visible in that preview.  LinkedIn

Once you either:

- export the Google Doc as a PDF/Docx and upload it, or
- make it viewable to anyone with the link,

I can extract everything, rewrite it, and even rank what should and shouldn't appear on your portfolio.

Design Specification v1.0

Design Philosophy

Professional first. Delight through interaction.

A recruiter should immediately understand:

- who you are
- what you build
- your strongest projects

Then, as they interact with the page, they slowly discover more of your personality.

The personality is **earned**, not forced.

Keywords

The website should feel:

- approachable
- polished
- thoughtful
- playful
- modern
- soft
- organized
- curious

Not:

- childish
 - cluttered
 - overly animated
 - "trying too hard"
-

Color Palette

Mostly neutral.

Think:

- warm white background
- very light gray cards
- soft shadows

Accent colors

- pastel blue
- pastel lavender
- muted mint

NOT rainbow.

The colors should mostly come from project images.

Typography

I actually think two fonts would work well.

Heading

A rounded geometric sans.

Body

A clean sans.

Something that feels between Apple and Material Design.

Avoid:

- handwritten
 - serif
 - overly thin fonts
-

Layout

The inspiration you showed strongly suggests

Hero

Hi, I'm Molly.

CS @ Columbia

I enjoy building thoughtful software
that solves real problems.

[Resume] [Projects]

(illustrated avatar)



Very spacious.

No walls of text.

About

One paragraph.

No autobiography.

Then

small stat cards.

 Columbia University



 CS

 6 Languages

 NYC / Chicago

 Productivity App Enjoyer

Experience

Timeline.

Very clean.

Card based.

Projects

Your strongest section.

Every project card

contains

Image

Title

2-line summary

Tech stack

Contribution chips

Learn more →

Instead of progress bars

I'd do this

My contributions

Frontend

AI

Backend

Research

But directly underneath

Represents where I spent the most time on this project.

No ambiguity.

Skills

Grouped.

Not alphabetical.

Example

Languages

Frameworks

AI

Design

Tools

Interests

This becomes one of the most memorable sections.

Instead of

Cats



Video Editing

Cooking

Every card flips.

Front



Cats

Back

I've probably said hi to
every friendly cat
on my block.



Microinteractions

This is where your personality comes out.

1. Language Hover ★ ★ ★ ★ ★

This is staying.

Hover

Projects



Projects



项目

Next hover



Projects



프로젝트

Next



Projects



โครงการ

Random every time.

One of my favorite ideas.

2. Avatar

I LOVE the avatar.

Not a real photo.

Not anime.

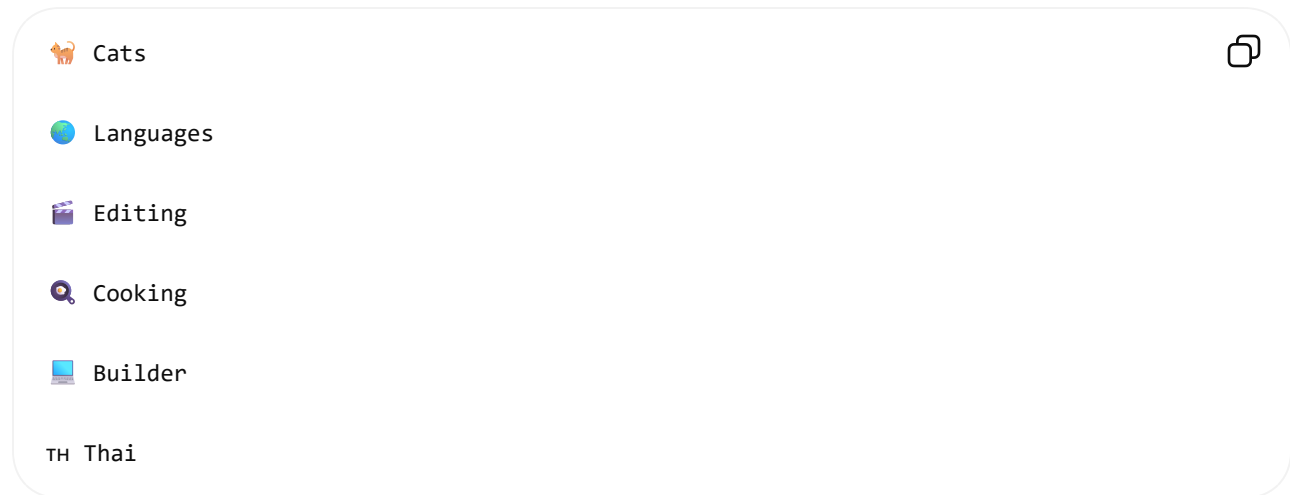
Think

Apple illustration.

Hover



Word bubbles



Animated outward.

Disappear.

3. Paw prints

Hover buttons.

Tiny paw prints.

Maybe 2.

Disappear after 300ms.

Perfect.

4. Project hover

Lift.

Shadow increases.

Image slowly zooms 3%.

Very subtle.

5. Interest cards

Flip.

Back reveals fun fact.

6. Contact

Instead of static icons.

Hover

LinkedIn

↓

Little bounce.

GitHub

↓

Tiny lift.

Email

↓

Envelope slides.

What should NOT animate

This is equally important.

Don't animate:

- paragraphs

- resume
- timeline
- skill lists
- scrolling every section dramatically

Animation should reward interaction, not interrupt reading.

One thing I want to add

Based on everything I know about you.

"Currently"

A tiny section.



Keeps the website alive.

Easy to update.

Content Structure

I'd recommend:

Hero



About



Featured Projects



Experience



Skills



Interests



Contact

No separate Awards page.

Instead

Inside About

Highlights



NCWIT Honorable Mention

National Merit Finalist

QuestBridge Scholar

Everyone Can Code

...

Content I can already extract

From LinkedIn + what we've worked on together, I'd feature something like this:

Hero

Hi, I'm Molly (Xinxi Zhong).

I'm a Computer Science student at Columbia University who enjoys building polished software, exploring AI, and crafting intuitive user experiences. Outside of coding, you'll usually find me learning languages, editing videos, or saying hello to every cat I meet.



Featured Projects

From our previous conversations:

- **Grami** — AI-powered cooking assistant
- **Pizza Builder Game** (Godot)
- **PhinTrack** (Finance desktop application)
- **Mood Calendar** (Swift/iOS)
- Any hackathon projects (especially if they have a polished demo)

I'd keep this to **4–6 projects**, with one or two highlighted as "featured" and the rest in a compact grid.

I also have one suggestion that wasn't on your list.

I think you should add a **"Behind the Build"** button to each project.

Instead of only showing the final product, let curious visitors expand a section with details like:

- Why you built it.
- The biggest technical challenge.
- One thing you'd redesign today.
- A screenshot of an early prototype or wireframe.

That kind of reflection is something interviewers often ask about anyway, and it reinforces the impression that you're a thoughtful builder, not someone who just finishes

assignments.

My next deliverable

Once you upload your current portfolio document, I can produce a polished design package that includes:

1. **A complete content rewrite** (hero, about, projects, experience, interests, contact).
2. **A Figma-style design specification** with exact spacing, typography, color palette, border radius, and animation timings.
3. **Three distinct homepage concepts** (wireframes with annotations) that all follow this design philosophy but differ in layout.
4. **A component library** (buttons, project cards, interest cards, timeline, avatar interactions, etc.) so the entire site feels consistent.

I think this will get you much closer to a portfolio that doesn't just list your accomplishments—it will communicate *who you are* within the first minute, while still being clean and recruiter-friendly.

 Sources

2025 iOS + ML Program App Prototype (Balanced Health):
<https://github.com/antares-v/balancedhealth> |
<https://www.figma.com/design/6OLR0D9BuXfLXtCxR0mZ2K/Balanced-Habits?m=auto&t=rxX2yN6MI0UWSDL6-1>
2025 App Accelerator (TrustPath):
<https://izaosha.wixsite.com/trustpath-1> | Project Overview |
<https://github.com/antares-v/TrustPath> |
<https://www.figma.com/design/ddfsbxi8xdvlfennzDuIV9/TrustPath-Wireframe?m=auto&t=rxX2yN6MI0UWSDL6-1>
DevFest 2026 (grami):
<https://devpost.com/software/grami-18m75d?>

Show more ▾

This is actually a much stronger portfolio than I initially thought. After looking at the project list, I think you're accidentally underselling yourself by treating everything equally. You have enough content now that the challenge is **curation**, not filling space.

My first impression of you now

If I were a recruiter, I'd summarize you like this:

Computer Science student who enjoys designing polished, user-centered software. Strong product thinking, experience from hackathons, internships, iOS, AI, web development, and UI/UX—not afraid to explore new technologies.

Notice I didn't say "AI engineer."

I think your strength is **end-to-end product building**, and your website should lean into that.

I would organize your projects like this

Instead of listing them chronologically:

★ Featured Projects

These get the large cards.

1. Grami (DevFest)

Category

Hackathon • AI • Full Stack

Why featured:

- AI
 - Hackathon
 - Team collaboration
 - Modern
 - Real users
-

2. TrustPath

Category

App Accelerator • Product Design

Shows

- research
- UX
- Figma
- product thinking
- iterative development

This one says a LOT about how you think.

3. Balanced Health

Category

iOS • Machine Learning

Shows

- Swift
 - ML
 - health
 - mobile development
-

Then below...

Other Projects

Smaller cards.

- PhinTrack
- Steel Egg Factory
- FuSSO Website
- Java Course

This creates a hierarchy.

I actually think your sections should be

Home



↓

About

↓

Featured Projects

↓

Experience

↓

Project Archive

↓

Skills

↓

Beyond Coding

↓

Contact

Notice

I renamed **Interests**.

I don't like "Interests"

It's generic.

I'd call it

Beyond Coding

or

Outside the IDE

or

Beyond the Screen

or

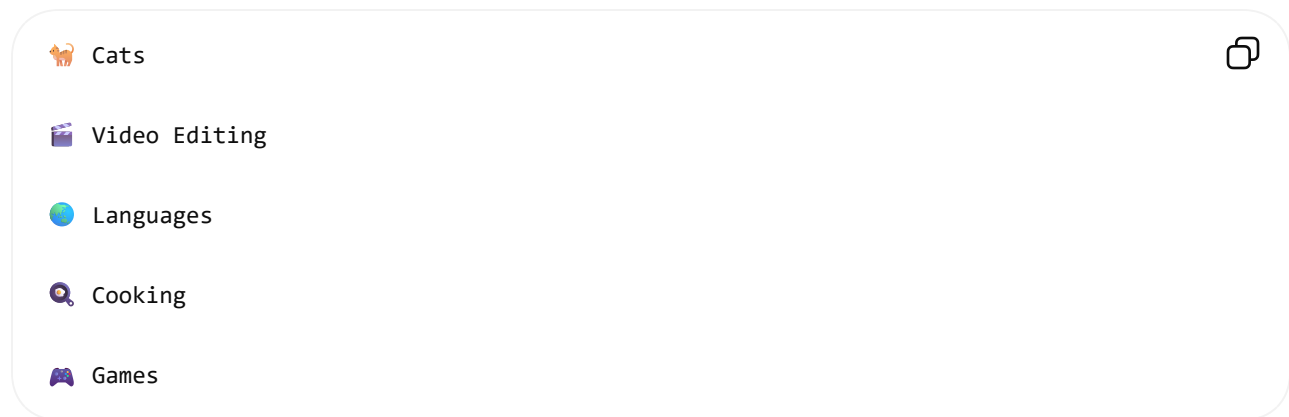
Things I Enjoy

My favorite:

Beyond Coding

It sounds professional but human.

Example:



Hover



fun fact

Perfect.

Hero section

I would rewrite it completely.

Instead of

Computer Science student...

I'd write something more memorable.

For example:

Hi! I'm Molly.

I'm a Computer Science student at Columbia University who enjoys turning ideas into polished, intuitive products. Whether it's an AI cooking assistant, an iOS app, or a hackathon prototype, I love solving real problems through thoughtful design and engineering.

Then

Resume



GitHub

LinkedIn

Email

About section

Very short.

Recruiters don't read essays.

Something like

I enjoy building software that people actually enjoy using. My interests span full-stack development, mobile apps, AI, and user experience, and I'm always looking for opportunities to combine technical problem-solving with thoughtful design.

Outside of coding, I'm usually learning languages, editing videos, experimenting in the kitchen, or searching for the next cat to say hello to.

Done.

Experience

Timeline.

Cards.

Everyone Can Code

Software Development Intern

Summer 2025

↓

Built...

↓

Learned...

Every experience gets

Biggest impact

instead of responsibilities.

Project cards

I have a very specific vision.

image

Grami

AI-powered cooking assistant...

Tech

Swift AI Firebase

Contribution

UX

██████ Backend

██████ AI

[View Project]

Hover



Tech chips expand.

Example

Swift



Built the entire mobile UI using SwiftUI.

Exactly what we talked about.

Project pages

Don't stop at cards.

Every featured project deserves its own page.

Overview



Problem



Solution



Features

↓

Tech Stack

↓

My Contributions

↓

Challenges

↓

Lessons Learned

↓

Gallery

↓

Links

This is much more interview-friendly.

Skills

Don't rate yourself.

Instead

Group.

Languages



Java

Python

Swift

JavaScript

SQL

Frameworks

React

Firebase

Flask

Node

Design

Figma

Adobe

Photoshop

Premiere

Simple.

Languages

This deserves its own little card.

Not buried in interests.

Languages

us English

CN Mandarin

HK Cantonese

TH Thai

KR Korean



es Spanish

Hover

↓

changes greeting.

That'll be cute.

The little interactions I think absolutely make the final cut

★ Random language hover

100%.

★ Paw prints

100%.

★ Interest flip cards

100%.

★ Avatar bubbles

100%.

★ Contribution chips

100%.

Everything else...

probably unnecessary.

My only new suggestion

I want to introduce one feature that I haven't mentioned before because your projects made me think of it.

"What I'm Exploring"

Unlike "Currently", this would be a tiny section that evolves over time and reflects your curiosity.

For example:

Currently Exploring



- AI coding agents
- SQL
- Better motion design
- React animations

It's a subtle signal that you're actively learning, and it naturally evolves with your interests. You don't need to pretend to be an expert in everything—you can show that you're curious and continuously building.

Finally... I think we should make this like a real design project.

Instead of jumping straight into code, I'd create these deliverables:

Phase 1 — Brand & Content

- Final sitemap
- Content writing
- Tone of voice
- Personal "brand statement"

Phase 2 — Design System

- Color palette
- Typography
- 8px spacing system
- Buttons

- Cards
- Shadows
- Motion guidelines

Phase 3 — Wireframes

- Desktop layouts
- Mobile layouts
- Responsive behavior
- Component hierarchy

Phase 4 — High-Fidelity Mockups

- Final homepage
- Project pages
- About page
- Contact page

Phase 5 — Development Plan

- Tech stack (I'd recommend **Next.js + Tailwind CSS + Framer Motion**)
- Folder structure
- Animation implementation
- Deployment

I genuinely think this deserves to be treated like one of your flagship projects. If we do it systematically, you'll end up with a portfolio that's not only attractive but also demonstrates the very skills you're trying to showcase: product thinking, UI/UX design, and polished engineering.

Can you give me a design document (so that I can send to other coding agents to produce designs) listing all the designs and components on the website, and include the styles we've discussed and the little unique pieces that add on to my personality

Below is a **clean, structured design document** you can directly hand to coding agents (or use as a spec for Next.js / Framer / Webflow / etc.).

I wrote it in a way that is:

- implementation-ready
 - component-based
 - style-guided
 - personality-layered (your “signature features” included separately so they don’t interfere with core UX)
-

PERSONAL PORTFOLIO DESIGN SPECIFICATION (v1.0)

1. Design Philosophy

The website is a **professional-first, personality-layered portfolio**.

Core Principle:

“Clarity first. Delight through interaction.”

Goals:

- Recruiter can understand profile in **<15 seconds**
 - Projects are easy to scan in **<1 minute**
 - Personality is discovered through interaction, not forced upfront
 - Website feels polished, modern, and calm—not busy or playful-heavy
-

2. Visual Style System

2.1 Overall Aesthetic

Inspired by:

- Apple UI design language
- Material Design (soft elevation)
- Clean portfolio layouts (air, spacing, hierarchy)

Style Keywords:

- minimal
- soft
- airy
- rounded
- subtle depth

- calm motion
-

2.2 Color Palette

Base Colors:

- Background: #FAFAF7 (warm white)
- Surface: #FFFFFF
- Border: #EAEAEA
- Text Primary: #1C1C1C
- Text Secondary: #6B6B6B

Accent Colors (limited use only):

- Soft Blue: #7AA6FF
- Soft Purple: #B7A6FF
- Soft Mint: #7FE3C5

Rules:

- Only ONE accent color per section
 - Personality colors appear only in:
 - hover states
 - tags
 - micro-interactions
-

2.3 Typography

Headings:

- Font: modern geometric sans (e.g. Inter / SF Pro / Manrope)
- Weight: 600–700

Body:

- Same family or secondary sans
- Weight: 400–500
- Line height: 1.5–1.7

Special Rule:

- Language labels (if used) may use slightly lighter weight for differentiation
-

2.4 Layout System

- 12-column grid (desktop)
 - 8px spacing system
 - Max width: 1100–1200px
 - Generous vertical spacing (section padding: 80–140px)
-

2.5 Shape Language

- Border radius: 12–20px (cards)
 - Buttons: 999px pill OR 12px rounded
 - No sharp corners
-

2.6 Motion System

Duration:

- Micro-interactions: 120–200ms
- Page transitions: 300–500ms
- Hover elevation: 150ms

Easing:

- ease-out for hover
- cubic-bezier for transitions (soft deceleration)

Motion Rules:

- No aggressive animation
 - Everything feels “light lifting”, not “moving around”
-

3. Site Structure (Sitemap)

/

- └─ Hero
- └─ About



- └─ Featured Projects
- └─ Experience
- └─ Project Archive
- └─ Skills
- └─ Beyond Coding (Interests)
- └─ Contact

Optional:

- /project/[slug] (project detail pages)

4. PAGE-BY-PAGE DESIGN

4.1 HERO SECTION

Layout:

Left:

- Name
- Title
- 1–2 sentence intro
- CTA buttons

Right:

- Illustrated avatar (cartoon version of user)

Content:

Name:

Molly (Xinxi Zhong)

Title:

CS @ Columbia University

Tagline:

Building thoughtful, polished software experiences

CTA Buttons:

- View Projects
 - Resume
 - Contact
-

Personality Layer (IMPORTANT):

Avatar Interaction:

On hover:

- 3–6 floating “word bubbles” appear:

Examples:

- 🐱 Cats
- 🌐 Languages
- 🎬 Video Editing
- 🍳 Cooking
- 💻 Builder
- 🇹🇭 Thai

Animation:

- outward float
 - fade out after ~1.5s
 - staggered timing
-

4.2 ABOUT SECTION

Layout:

Two-column layout:

- left: text
 - right: stat cards
-

Content:

Short paragraph:

- product-minded builder
 - enjoys UX + engineering
 - multilingual
 - creative hobbies
-

Stat Cards:

- Columbia University CS
 - 6 Languages
 - Hackathon Experience
 - iOS + Web + AI projects
 - NYC-based
-

Subsection: Highlights

- internships
 - awards
 - notable programs
-

4.3 FEATURED PROJECTS (MOST IMPORTANT SECTION)

Layout:

Vertical stacked cards OR 2-column grid

Project Card Component:

Structure:

[Image Preview]



Project Title

1-2 line description

Tech chips:

Swift • Firebase • AI

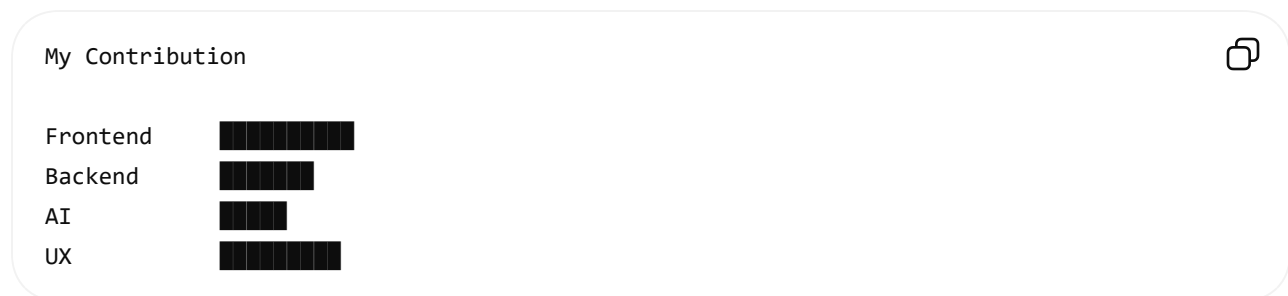
Contribution Breakdown (IMPORTANT)

[View Project]

Contribution Breakdown (YOUR SIGNATURE COMPONENT)

Instead of skill bars:

Format:



Rule:

Must include label:

“Represents where I spent effort in this project”

Prevents misunderstanding.

Featured Projects List:

1. Grami (DevFest)
2. TrustPath (App Accelerator)
3. Balanced Health (iOS + ML)

4.4 EXPERIENCE SECTION

Layout:

Timeline vertical cards

Each card:

- role

- organization
- duration
- 2–3 bullet highlights

Focus:

- impact
 - what you built
 - what you learned
-

4.5 PROJECT ARCHIVE

Smaller grid cards

Same structure but:

- less detail
 - no contribution breakdown
 - quick scan format
-

4.6 SKILLS SECTION

Grouped categories:

- Languages
 - Frameworks
 - Tools
 - Design
-

Format:

Simple tag pills:

Swift Python Java SQL
React Firebase Flask
Figma Photoshop



No proficiency bars.

4.7 BEYOND CODING (INTERESTS)

Component: Flip Cards

Front:

- icon
- label

Back (hover):

- 1 fun fact

Examples:



Cats →

"I greet every cat I see."



Video Editing →

"Once spent 4 hours perfecting a 40s clip."



Languages →

"Comfortable in 6 languages."



Cooking →

"I like experimenting with simple dishes."

Layout:

2–3 rows grid

4.8 CONTACT SECTION

Minimal layout:

- Email
- LinkedIn
- GitHub

Hover:

- slight lift
- paw print trail effect (subtle)

5. GLOBAL SIGNATURE INTERACTIONS (PERSONALITY LAYER)

These are optional but define your identity.

5.1 RANDOM LANGUAGE HOVER (KEY FEATURE ★)

Applied ONLY to:

- nav items
- section headers

Behavior:

"Projects" randomly cycles:

- Projects
- 项目
- 프로젝트
- โครงการ

Rules:

- must stay same meaning
 - smooth vertical swap animation
-

5.2 PAW PRINT MICROINTERACTION

When hovering buttons:

- 1–2 tiny paw prints appear behind cursor entry direction
 - fade within 300ms
-

5.3 AVATAR BUBBLES

On hover:

- personality tags float outward
 - soft fade
-

5.4 INTERACTION DEPTH RULE

- Hover = lift
- Click = deepen
- Scroll = reveal

No chaotic animation.

5.5 EASTER EGG (OPTIONAL)

Hidden cat appears randomly once per session:

- small icon
 - clickable → "You found a cat "
-

6. CONTENT TONE OF VOICE

- simple
 - confident but not arrogant
 - slightly warm
 - no overly formal corporate tone
-

7. COMPONENT LIBRARY (FOR CODING AGENTS)

Core Components:

- HeroSection
- AvatarCard
- FloatingWordBubble
- ProjectCard
- ContributionChart
- TechChip
- TimelineCard
- SkillTag
- FlipInterestCard
- NavBar
- SectionHeader (with language swap)
- ContactCard

Shared UI Patterns:

- Card elevation system
 - Hover lift animation
 - Soft shadow system
 - Rounded corners consistency
-

8. WHAT MAKES THIS PORTFOLIO UNIQUE

This is your differentiator system:

NOT gimmicks

But layered identity:

1. Language switching microinteraction
 2. Avatar personality bubbles
 3. Contribution DNA charts
 4. Flip-card interests
 5. Paw print microinteractions
-

9. FINAL DESIGN GOAL

When someone closes your site, they should remember:

"This is a technically strong builder who also clearly cares about crafting delightful, thoughtful experiences—and has a very global, creative personality."

If you want next step, I can:

1. turn this into a **Figma wireframe layout** (screen-by-screen)
2. or generate a **Next.js component folder structure**
3. or define a **motion design spec** (Framer Motion ready)